

TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 6 OF SIX

Peace, Shared Songs and My Unpaid Portrait

Native cooperative games, shared puzzles and stories for an optional companion

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.

Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan's creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.

Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden’s scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [Peace Could Not Be Purchased with My Portrait Budget](#) - page 27. Coalition, resources and accountability.

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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 6. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P201	P202	P203	P204	P205	P206	P207	P208
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3. Willing to inspect a thing	P217	P218	P219	P220	P221	P222	P223	P224
4. Here for the atmosphere	P225	P226	P227	P228	P229	P230	P231	P232
5. Open to a wildcard	P233	P234	P235	P236	P237	P238	P239	P240

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The Rehearsal Had Two Controllers and One Unnecessary Throne

I placed two controllers on a velvet cushion beneath the portrait. It was meant to suggest equality. Tank looked at the cushion, then at the only chair facing the screen.

'Where's the other person sit?'

Nigga, equality had arrived ahead of the furniture.

Rae pulled up a second chair. Nia moved the cushion so both controllers could reach their cables. My wife sat in the chair I had reserved for the host and asked whether I planned to stand there explaining the arrangement all night.

'I'm establishing the mood.'

'You've established a queue.'

The final wording waited in its folder. The signing table stood level, the light reached the page and Mika had timed the walk from the buffet without including any pause for my autobiography. We were going to try sharing actual controls before celebrating an agreement about sharing a room.

Dez arrived wearing the disputed jacket. Auntie June followed carrying its empty hanger.

'Evidence,' June told me.

Dez said a hanger could not prove the weather in 1967. June said she had brought it to hang the coat, which was a far more devastating reply than any courtroom flourish I could have supplied. Both veterans still claimed the other had never signed the old Blue Comet agreement. This one had acquired enough working pens to alarm a stationery wholesaler. I had bought the gold one. Nia preferred the plain black one because it actually wrote.

Rae tested both. 'Yours writes too,' she told Nia. 'Just not in a recognised direction.'

Nia smiled. 'You understood the invitation.'

'Eventually.'

They would dance after the signing. Their only unresolved question was whether Rae could persuade Nia that being good at a contract did not require counting every step before the music began.

Kit had her karaoke song ready and her reading glasses attached to a cord. Remy admired the practical innovation, then discovered his crown prevented him from putting on his headphones. Velvet Payroll removed the crown, set it on the table and told him to preserve his head for the performance. She had been paid, her shoes were fastened and her stage time existed on an actual clock. A powerful woman with excellent grounds for happiness.

Mercedes checked the music. Porsche checked that the photographer understood which pictures people wanted. Nobody needed another staged candid in which Rae pretended not to notice a lens six inches from her coffee.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Dre brought the blue controller and a casserole. He was a Crip with a hot dish, not an available metaphor for my summit title. He wanted a clear space to set the food and the particular colour of plastic he had chosen.

I offered the gold controller. 'Nigga, you keep the expensive-looking problem,' he said.

Darnell appeared behind him with a little case and an offer to sponsor fireworks. Velvet asked whether the sponsorship involved money or cocaine. He said relationships. She told him her actual relationships had already paid for the show.

He tried describing a yacht. The host opened the lift before the description acquired a second deck. Darnell went to find a different audience. Dre stayed to ask Rosa whether the casserole needed warming.

Mika suggested using the model hotel to rehearse the procession. I liked the idea until they assigned my paper figure to hold the door.

'I have a speaking role.'

'You have a useful arm,' Rae said.

Shawna kissed that arm through my sleeve. Suddenly the assignment developed possibilities.

Some games would give two people separate characters. Some would divide their information. Some would give one person a smaller helping role. Others could simply be enjoyed together with one person operating the controls.

June said she might watch. Dez said she might try. Neither statement triggered an emergency meeting.

I looked up at the portrait, whose enormous expression appeared to endorse every arrangement. That was generous of it, considering the evening had still authorised none of its cost.

Then Rae handed Nia a controller and asked which role she wanted. A normal question, asked without a trumpet.

I sat beside Shawna, took the other available chair properly and waited to hear the answer.

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War had reached the dangerous stage where people might enjoy themselves enough to forget who was supposed to receive credit.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P201 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Secret of Mana

Edition considered: 1993 SNES original / Collection of Mana on Switch; not 2018 remake

Explore a colourful retro adventure together once companions join, with towns, magic and party equipment giving the shared journey a continuing sense of purpose.

What you do. Move through connected areas, fight enemies in real time and use ring menus to manage the party's items, equipment and magic.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Real-time combat and held actions remain; original SNES three-player play needs an adapter, and cooperation begins after allies join.

Why it might click. The original 1993 adventure offers a colourful party journey with native cooperative fighting once companions join. Its overhead view removes free-camera steering, while towns, equipment, magic and connected areas give the journey continuity.

The full catch. Combat runs in real time. Original manual instructions include held dashing and charged attacks, plus Y opening the paused ring menu. Original SNES two-player play needs two controllers; a third needs a multiplayer adapter. Collection of Mana supports up to three. The 2018 remake is excluded.

Try this first. Enjoy the solo opening together or use an existing shared save after an ally joins. Try moving, opening the ring and one familiar encounter. The second player should choose their own role rather than automatically receiving every difficult job.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P201 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Secret of Mana

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hero Had to Wait for His Friends

Secret of Mana's party adventure made me offer to be the summit's central hero. Auntie June asked whether that position involved carrying chairs. I said it involved vision.

'Then carry two,' she replied. 'One for each eye.'

Dez laughed into her tea. June had been telling her what needed moving since the Blue Comet dispute of 1967; the instructions had apparently improved with age.

The original game's companions had to join before shared control became available. Rae liked that the plan required checking the actual party rather than handing out imaginary jobs.

I carried the chairs. Nia tested the second controller with Rae while Tank found the correct cable. Nobody appointed me commander of their buttons.

Dez touched the jacket folded beside her. 'She lent this with a lecture about the pockets.' June said a borrower deserved to know where things went.

Both women accepted the dry chairs I supplied. Nigga, I had achieved a modest diplomatic victory entirely through furniture.

Aiden's verdict. Try the original adventure if its real-time demands and hardware arrangement suit. The appointed hero has discovered that a useful party member sometimes begins by carrying two chairs.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo Collection of Mana page confirms original Secret of Mana supports 1-3 players. Original manual text inspected through archival transcription establishes ring pause, held actions and SNES controller/adaptor rules. Ally-gated joining follows party availability. No 2018 PC remake metadata is used.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/en-ca/store/products/collection-of-mana-switch/>

Source 2: https://www.world-of-nintendo.com/manuals/super_nes/secret_of_mana.shtml

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P202 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Spiritfarer: Farewell Edition

Edition considered: PC Farewell Edition

Build and travel on a ferry while caring for spirits, sharing everyday chores and eventually saying goodbye to people whose stories become familiar.

What you do. Explore islands, gather resources, cook and craft, build the boat, and try Stella's or Daffodil's role in local cooperation.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Chores and resources accumulate, roles differ, and later timed challenges remain alongside jumping, gliding and bereavement.

Why it might click. Build and travel on a ferry, care for spirits, gather materials and eventually say goodbye. The Farewell Edition includes the expanded character stories. Native local cooperation pairs Stella with Daffodil, giving two people a shared place to inhabit.

The full catch. Movement includes jumping and gliding; chores, recipes and resources accumulate. The cat's role differs from Stella's. A previously inspected secondary walkthrough identifies Elena's later timed Gold Dragon challenge, so the gentle presentation is not a no-rush guarantee. Bereavement is the central theme.

Try this first. Meet a passenger, walk around the boat and try one chore in each role. Check whether both people enjoy what their character can do. Leave the larger building plan alone until the small shared activity feels worthwhile.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P202 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Spiritfarer: Farewell Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ferry Had Room for Another Chair

Spiritfarer's ferry made Mika describe our convention floor as a vessel carrying everyone toward a farewell. Velvet asked whether the vessel had paid its entertainment bill.

'Yes,' I said proudly. She checked her phone. 'It has. Continue floating.'

June wanted a seat near Dez without sitting beneath the speaker. Tank found one. Rosa brought tea and asked whether either wanted anything in it.

The game's caring chores and eventual goodbyes gave the room a quieter subject. Dez remembered replacing the borrowed jacket's worn lining. June remembered choosing the colour.

They disagreed gently about the colour. Neither disputed that someone had kept the coat.

Nia and Rae tried their different roles without pretending they were identical. I offered to supervise their shared voyage. Shawna asked me to carry the empty cups back instead.

On my return, June was showing Dez a photograph. Velvet had sat down to listen. Our vessel had finally stopped announcing every passenger over the public-address system.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the caring ferry journey if its chores, unequal roles and bereavement feel welcome. Our vessel now serves tea without demanding that every passenger deliver a farewell speech.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam publisher description confirms Farewell Edition activities and local Daffodil cooperation. Prior inspected GuideStrats walkthrough supplies the secondary-source warning about Elena and the timed Gold Dragon; not represented as a developer access statement.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/972660/>

Source 2: <https://guidestrats.com/spiritfarer-elena-guide/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P203 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Pode

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

Guide a rock and fallen star through beautiful caverns, combining their different abilities to solve spatial puzzles and bring the environment to life together.

What you do. Move the two characters, explore cave rooms and coordinate their positions and special abilities to open ways forward.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Spatial positioning and movement still need checking; gentle art does not establish no held actions, tricky jumps or timed sections.

Why it might click. A rock and a fallen star explore Norwegian-inspired caverns, using different abilities to bring an ancient environment to life and solve spatial puzzles. The Switch edition supports one or two players on one system.

The full catch. You still move characters through three-dimensional spaces and coordinate their positions and abilities. The store's cooperative and gentle-looking presentation does not prove no held movement, no tricky jumps or no timed sections throughout. The assigned edition is Switch; PC controller requirements are not imported here.

Try this first. Try the first shared room and let each person explain what their character appears able to change. Check movement, positioning and the viewpoint before tackling a long puzzle. Switch roles only if both people would like to.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P203 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Pode

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Fallen Star Wanted Its Own Billing

Pode's rock and fallen star gave Remy and Velvet an irresistible casting dispute. He wanted to be the star. She asked whether his contract supported that interpretation.

'I'm naturally luminous,' he said. 'You're standing under my lamp,' she replied.

Rae wanted to try the characters' different abilities. Nia chose the other role, then asked what Rae needed from her before either moved.

I declared this an ideal model for the signing. Mika immediately assigned me the heavy end of the table. Nigga, somehow I kept auditioning for light and being cast as rock.

Remy and Velvet settled their quarrel by taking turns, discovering that each preferred doing something different from what they had predicted.

Kit adjusted the real lamp so both could see. She refused to select a winner for the billing dispute.

The beautiful caverns kept their spatial puzzles. Our room solved one of its own when the table stopped blocking a chair.

Shawna admired my effort. I asked whether I glowed. 'A little sweaty,' she said.

Aiden's verdict. Try the complementary pair if its movement and spatial coordination suit both players. My rock performance has cleared a chair, and the star may negotiate its own lamp.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/pode-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

- | | | | | |
|----------------------|--------------------|---------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| Niggas, games up. | Niggas, pens out. | Niggas, chairs in. | Niggas, snacks here. | Niggas, receipts ready. |
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P204 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Stardew Valley

Edition considered: PC current release; platform and version must be recorded

Grow a farm and become familiar with a community, sharing work and exploration while seasons, friendships and personal projects give the place continuity.

What you do. Plant crops, manage tools and resources, visit neighbours and explore activities together in the chosen cooperative PC setup.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. The active day, inventories and multiple activities add pressure; verify multiplayer pause behavior before expecting menus to stop time.

Why it might click. Farming, friendships, seasons, crafting and exploration create a place that can grow alongside a group. The current inspected PC listing advertises online cooperation and shared-screen support, allowing genuine joint work rather than only discussion beside one controller.

The full catch. An active day, energy, inventories, travel, fishing and combat create different demands. Multiplayer pause behavior must be checked; a partner does not automatically stop the clock. Many recipes and social schedules can turn leisure into planning. Record the actual installed version before comparing features.

Try this first. Plant a small patch or take one walk together. Inspect movement, item selection and what happens to time when a menu opens. Avoid choosing a mining or fishing challenge as the sole measure of whether village life appeals.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P204 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Stardew Valley

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Farm Did Not Recognise My Opening Bell

Stardew Valley made Rosa imagine a small farm with enough room for flowers and no stage. Tank immediately asked what they would grow for dinner.

I offered to fund an agricultural wing of the summit. Rae asked whether it came with a portrait on the barn. My pause answered before I did.

Nia wanted to understand the active day and shared setup before promising an evening of joint farming. Rae agreed. They chose one modest task instead of naming an estate.

June said the Blue Comet had once tried growing herbs behind the kitchen. Dez said June had watered the same plastic basil for a month.

'It stayed green,' June replied.

The game had enough tools, seasons and activities without my bell announcing every crop. Rosa and Tank looked at the starting work together and kept their plans small.

Shawna took the bell from my hand. 'This is why nobody lets you near livestock.'

I told her I possessed pastoral charm. She asked me to demonstrate it by remaining seated.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the shared farm if its active days and management appeal after checking multiplayer pacing. Our agricultural wing remains a single conversation with no portrait on the barn.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/413150/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P205 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Minecraft

Edition considered: Java & Bedrock Edition for PC; editions need separate control profiles

Create a shared place from blocks in Creative mode, using unlimited resources to focus on a modest build instead of surviving the world's dangers.

What you do. Look around, move through the world and place or remove blocks while coordinating a building project on compatible editions and devices.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Camera movement and precise placement remain; Java and Bedrock differ, and PC versions do not provide console-style split-screen.

Why it might click. Creative mode supplies unlimited resources, damage immunity and flight for shared building. Java and Bedrock both support multiplayer, but they have different compatibility and input profiles. A modest construction can give two people an enjoyable shared purpose.

The full catch. Moving while steering a three-dimensional view and precisely placing blocks can be substantial work. Creative mode changes survival pressure, not those demands. Official comparison lists controller support for Bedrock, not Java, and split-screen only on consoles; do not plan PC couch split-screen.

Try this first. Choose the exact edition and arrange compatible separate-device play if sharing online or locally. In Creative mode, try looking around and placing a few blocks before planning anything large. A wall with one window is an adequate architectural brief.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P205 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Minecraft

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Peace Palace Had No Back Door

Minecraft's Creative mode encouraged Mika to propose a block-built model of the signing room. I began with a triumphal entrance tall enough to accommodate my reputation.

Rae began with the table. Nia added space around it. Tank asked where a person could leave. I pointed proudly at the triumphal entrance.

'Without walking through your announcement,' he clarified.

June said the Blue Comet had one narrow exit and too many people trying to look unbothered in it. Dez said June had blocked it while arguing about the jukebox.

Mika added another door. The model improved instantly.

The camera and placement still needed an actual trial, and compatible editions mattered before anyone promised a shared build. Meanwhile, our imaginary architecture was already learning from the people who would use it.

I put a tiny portrait above the entrance. Shawna moved it into a side room. 'Private collection,' she said.

Nigga, my first museum had opened without public funding or a compulsory route through it.

Aiden's verdict. Build together in a compatible setup if camera movement and placement suit. The model's second door stays open, and its portrait collection may be visited entirely by choice.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.minecraft.net/en-us/about-minecraft>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P206 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Animal Crossing: New Horizons

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game

Make an island home through collecting, crafting, decorating and meeting animal neighbours, with different ways to spend time alongside other players on Switch.

What you do. Walk around the island, speak with residents, gather materials and place objects while trying the specific shared-system or visiting mode.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Storage, tools and repeated menus add work; shared-system roles and installed-version restrictions need checking before assuming equal freedom.

Why it might click. Collect materials, meet animal neighbours and gradually arrange an island home. The current Switch page supports up to four people sharing one system and larger visits with separate systems, though these are different ways of playing together.

The full catch. Crafting, tool selection, storage and repeated dialogue can create menu work. Same-system roles and restrictions deserve a practical check before assuming everyone has identical freedom. The page reflects current updates, so check the installed version; this card does not certify every activity as untimed.

Try this first. Walk around, talk to one neighbour and try placing or collecting an object. If playing together, test the specific visiting or shared-system mode and let both people describe what they can actually do. An unproductive beach stroll is a valid result.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, read first.

Niggas, we're good.

P206 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Animal Crossing: New Horizons

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Island Host Misplaced His Mandate

Animal Crossing's island home made me ask what sort of neighbour I would be. Rosa said one who installed a fountain before learning when the bins went out.

I called that civic ambition. Rae called it plumbing with an audience.

Kit wanted a quiet corner to decorate. Remy wanted to visit and bring something ridiculous. They checked which shared mode actually gave them the freedom they expected.

Dez remembered how the old club's jukebox had acquired a handwritten AUNTIE JUNE'S CHOICE sign. June said it was temporary. 'It lasted longer than the curtains,' Dez replied.

Nia wrote the new jukebox sentence plainly: everybody could choose songs, and nobody's name owned the machine.

I asked whether the host received priority. Seven faces turned toward me. Nigga, the island had developed a remarkably efficient weather system.

Shawna suggested I bring a useful gift instead. I offered the gold fountain. She asked for batteries.

I found batteries. My promising career as a neighbour survived its first planning objection.

Aiden's verdict. Make an island home if the chosen shared mode and its restrictions fit. Our host has exchanged priority at the jukebox for the more useful privilege of supplying batteries.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/animal-crossing-new-horizons-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P207 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Portal 2

Edition considered: PC release

Solve a dedicated two-player puzzle campaign together, using portals and complementary perspectives to discover how unusual test chambers can be crossed or rearranged.

What you do. Walk and look around in first person, aim portals and coordinate actions with the other player to solve chambers.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. First-person aiming and coordinated manoeuvres remain substantial catches; the timed-input declaration is not a complete cooperative-play audit.

Why it might click. The dedicated two-player campaign has its own robots, story and chambers designed around joint portal solutions. Humour and mechanical discoveries make it attractive to companions who like discussing how a space works.

The full catch. First-person movement, aiming, spatial transformations and coordinating actions remain substantial catches. Steam declares play without timed input, but that declaration is not a tested guarantee that every cooperative manoeuvre avoids urgency or awkward timing. Both camera comfort and joint execution need direct trials.

Try this first. Enter the cooperative introduction and test looking, walking and placing a portal before pursuing a complex solution. Describe a location without pointing at the other person's screen. Stop if the camera or required coordination outweighs the pleasure of solving.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P207 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Portal 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Portal Opened Onto My Own Mistake

Portal 2's cooperative chambers made me and Rae a dangerous combination: she wanted to understand the route, and I wanted to explain it before looking.

'Over there,' I said. 'Where?' 'By the significant wall.'

She turned toward me. 'Nigga, every wall got significance if you walk into it.' Nia laughed so suddenly that her pen rolled under the table.

We stopped to retrieve it. Rae described what she could actually see. I finally looked at my own view and discovered I had been discussing the wrong direction with magnificent confidence.

The first-person aiming and coordinated actions were real things to test. My commentary was an optional obstacle.

Across the room, Remy rehearsed his entrance through one door while Velvet left through another. Mika asked them to exchange places. They managed without inventing interdimensional law.

I gave Rae one clear description. She answered with one useful instruction. Something worked.

Shawna applauded softly. 'A portal to competence,' she said. I resisted announcing that I had designed it.

Aiden's verdict. Try the dedicated cooperative puzzles if first-person aiming and coordination suit both people. The host's directional commentary is now required to identify an actual place before becoming advice.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/620/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P208 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Untitled Goose Game

Edition considered: PC release with two-player update

Cause slapstick trouble together in a village, coordinating distractions and stealing objects while watching the inhabitants react to two very determined geese and their pranks.

What you do. Move around the village, honk, handle objects and work together to distract people or complete comic tasks.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Pursuit and useful timing occur in real time; object handling and later time challenges need checking despite the charming premise.

Why it might click. The updated PC game lets two people play the whole village prank campaign together. Watching people react, coordinating distractions and creating ridiculous little situations can be as entertaining as completing the written objectives.

The full catch. Stealth, pursuit, object handling and positioning operate in real time. Some tasks require observing routines and acting at a useful moment; held inputs and later time challenges need checking. A charming goose is still capable of making a control scheme demanding.

Try this first. Explore the first garden together and try moving, honking and handling one object before attempting an elaborate prank. Agree whether either person wants hints. Enjoy an accidental comic moment without turning every task into a performance target.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P208 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Untitled Goose Game

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Two Geese and an Unattended Sash

Untitled Goose Game put two determined troublemakers before us. Velvet and Remy exchanged a look I should have recognised as a warning about my unattended ceremonial sash.

I was explaining how shared mischief required trust when Velvet asked me to inspect a stage light. Remy quietly lifted the sash from my chair.

By the time I returned, it decorated the buffet's bread basket. GRAND CONVENOR OF ROLLS, Kit announced.

Rae laughed hard enough to lean against Nia. Nia caught her elbow and kept laughing too. The summit had found its first completely unanimous resolution.

The geese's real-time trouble still needed a practical control check. Our trouble required only leaving two entertainers bored within reach of fabric.

I went to reclaim my office. Rosa put a fresh roll into my hand and said the basket wore the sash well. Shawna untied it after everyone had eaten. 'You can have your title back now.'

Nigga, I had been defeated by two performers and temporarily replaced by bread.

Aiden's verdict. Try the comic mischief if pursuit and object handling feel enjoyable. Our ceremonial sash may return to its owner once the bread basket finishes its entirely successful term.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/837470/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P209 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Unravel Two

Edition considered: PC release

Help two connected Yarnys through beautiful environments, using their physical link to turn movement and obstacles into a shared puzzle with an emotional story.

What you do. Run, jump, swing and help the other Yarny cross obstacles while exploring the route together in local cooperative play.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Active platforming and chases remain; being linked can add coordination pressure when the two players want different paces.

Why it might click. Two Yarnys work through natural and built environments, helping one another across obstacles. Native local cooperation makes the physical connection between characters a direct shared puzzle, with an emotional story running through the journey.

The full catch. This is an active platforming game: jumping, swinging, running and reaction demands are explicit. Coordination can amplify frustration when one person wants a slower pace. Its warmth does not establish an easy route through every chase or challenge; check any assistance options in the actual build.

Try this first. In an early safe area, each person should try movement and one simple shared traversal. Ask whether being physically linked feels funny and satisfying or restrictive. Do not make completing a chase the admission test for an enjoyable evening.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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P209 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Unravel Two

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ribbon Connected Two Unrelated Plans

Unravel Two's connected Yarnys made Mika suggest a ribbon linking the two ceremonial pens. I approved the symbolism before asking whether anyone planned to move them.

Rae tested one pen. Nia reached for the other. The ribbon caught my champagne flute and brought it halfway across the cloth.

'Beautiful unity,' Rae said. 'Where do you want the spill?'

I blamed insufficient tension. Kit said that was the first inaccurate description of the room all evening. The game's physical connection could create shared possibilities and coordination demands. Our pens needed to stay ordinary pens. Mika cut the ribbon and tied two small bows instead.

June took one bow and attached it to the jacket Dez had been carrying. Dez pretended to object, then straightened it carefully.

Nia tested the free pen again. Her signature still looked like a bird escaping a saucepan. Rae said she could recognise it now.

Shawna rescued my flute. 'You can connect with me later,' she whispered. 'Without tying anything to the table.'

Aiden's verdict. Consider the linked platforming if its active demands and shared pace suit. Our signing pens now travel independently, leaving affection free to use a less hazardous connection.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1225570/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P210 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

80 Days

Edition considered: PC release

Plan an alternate-history journey around the world, balancing routes and resources while conversations and unexpected encounters give each trip its own character and possibilities.

What you do. Choose destinations and transport, read encounters, manage luggage and money, and consider Fogg's wellbeing along the route.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Travel deadlines and schedules add pressure; inspect clock behavior, and remember shared discussion is not native cooperative control.

Why it might click. As Passepartout, choose routes and encounters across an alternate-history world while managing Fogg's wellbeing, money and travel. This is single-player storytelling that can be discussed beside the screen; its shared appeal does not make it native cooperative play.

The full catch. The premise includes a travel deadline, schedules and an in-game clock. The inspected store language stresses continuous time, so do not assume a fully untimed experience or confuse the multiplayer journey feed with joint control. Reading, inventory and route planning are significant.

Try this first. Inspect the opening route choices and how time behaves in each screen before committing to a journey. Let the person operating choose whether advice is welcome. One interesting encounter is enough to assess the prose and decision rhythm.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P210 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

80 Days

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Eighty Days to Find the Correct Coat

80 Days made June describe the old jacket's supposed travels. According to her, it had visited three cities before Dez remembered that borrowing eventually involved returning.

Dez said June had recommended two of those cities herself. 'Then you kept the coat,' June said. 'Because you said the weather looked terrible.'

I offered to commission a map. Rae asked whether the map would arrive before the jacket already sitting on the chair beside us.

Nia wanted a simple settlement: the coat could be returned, lent again when asked, and kept out of the expense claim for my portrait.

'That last bit wandered in,' I said. 'Like the coat,' Shawna replied.

The game had routes, luggage and schedules to weigh. Our shared discussion needed no extra controller, but it did need me to stop proposing freight insurance for a sixty-year argument.

Dez draped the jacket over June's shoulders to check the fit. June smiled.

Nobody called that surrender. Tank called it time to bring the dessert trolley closer.

Aiden's verdict. Plan the journey together if its reading and travel pressure appeal, remembering it remains shared discussion. The coat's latest route covers one chair and requires no commemorative map.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/381780/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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Peace Could Not Be Purchased with My Portrait Budget

The disagreement started with a line on the hotel's final service sheet: HOST TO DETERMINE PARTICIPANT SUITABILITY. I thought it meant deciding who could fit into Remy's spare crown.

Nia read it again. Rae put down her water.

'Suitable for what?' Rae asked.

The floor manager said it was standard wording. Nigga, people kept presenting standard as though it meant nobody had chosen it.

Kit asked whether it gave the door staff discretion to stop a guest who looked difficult. The manager said they would use judgment.

'Whose?' June asked.

I began saying the hotel was very welcoming. Shawna touched my sleeve. 'Let them answer.'

The manager explained that the host could approve the guest list. I was the host. Suddenly the expensive room had handed me a power I had been enjoying without examining its edges.

Rae said a security guard had asked her twice that afternoon whether she was working here. The second time, she was carrying her own coffee. Kit had walked beside her with a lighting cable and received a welcome.

'I told him she was with us,' Kit said.

Rae looked at her. 'I was already with myself.'

Kit nodded, embarrassed. 'I know. That's what came out.'

'It helped him stop asking. It also made you the person who could confirm I belonged.'

The manager said the guard was only checking. Velvet asked why checking had required the same person twice.

I recognised the expression on the manager's face. It was the one I used when I wanted a complaint to become a misunderstanding before anybody priced the remedy.

Nia did not translate Rae's sentence into nicer language. She asked the manager to answer it.

He could not explain the difference in treatment. He said he would speak to the guard.

Rae asked what would happen if it happened again while everybody was busy watching the stage. The manager gave his own name and said he would stay on the floor. Mika wrote down the number he supplied and checked that the phone rang.

A small test. No fanfare. A real person expected to answer.

Kit said she would correct her own introduction if it happened again. 'I don't need to tell him you're with me. I need to tell him he's already been answered.'

'And when I'm not standing there,' Rae said.

'Yes.'

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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The manager took the sheet away to replace the vague line. I watched him go, wondering why it had seemed so harmless until somebody described being on its receiving end.

June set her cup down. 'Your invitation put us on opposite sides before we got through the door. Then your hotel decided who looked like staff.'

I said the war title was a joke.

'I laughed,' she replied. 'I'm still asking you something.'

That stopped me more effectively than anger would have. I knew how to posture against an accusation. I had less practice staying still inside a question asked by someone who did not need to dislike me.

Rae touched the edge of the table she had repaired. 'I like making things work. I don't want that to become the price of being the kind of woman I am in this room.'

Kit said she recognised the temptation to earn welcome through competence. Then she stopped herself.

'That's my experience,' she said. 'It doesn't finish yours.'

Rae nodded. The distinction did not turn either of them into an enemy.

June tapped the portrait crate, where my folded war banner now lived. 'And I remain a Black butch whether your campaign knows where to put me or not. Don't use me as the exception that excuses the arrangement.'

'I won't,' I said.

She waited. I checked the entrance myself. The new signs named the rooms and where to ask for help. The banner stayed in its crate. The main title could remain the title of our absurd story without becoming sorting instructions for arriving guests.

Dez watched me straighten a sign. 'Careful with the corner. That's how jackets start wars.'

The laugh helped. It did not return the conversation to where it had been.

Mika brought the remaining staff costs. The performers had been paid, but the technicians' booked finish time came before the extra photographs I had requested. Someone would be packing down while I pretended the room existed indefinitely.

I offered the portrait's lighting budget.

'That money is already spent,' Nia said.

'A symbolic transfer.'

'The technician takes actual money,' Velvet replied.

Remy asked to cut his second entrance so the work could end on time. Velvet refused to solve my extension by making his performance smaller. Kit offered to shorten her own song, then admitted she did not really want to.

Nobody applauded her sacrifice. She looked relieved.

Rosa said the people clearing plates also had homes to reach. Tank moved the empty trays onto the trolley instead of describing his solidarity with the catering profession.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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I asked the manager for the real cost of the time I had added. He returned with a number. It was less than the frame around my face.

Nigga, the comparison did something unpleasant to my priorities.

I paid the extension. We also ended the extra photo session early. Money bought the agreed work; it did not make staying late everyone's natural obligation.

Nia put the corrected sheet beside the game-night charter. 'These are arrangements for tonight. They don't buy forgiveness, desire or a story in which everybody now understands everybody.'

Mika put the remaining voluntary contributions on the table. The money had been collected for microphones and getting people home. I suggested applying it to the hotel's final total. Velvet asked which contributors had agreed to buy my decorations.

Kit pushed the envelope back toward Mika. 'I put in what I could. That doesn't buy me a better chair, and it doesn't become somebody else's portrait because the cheque was small.'

Rae proposed checking each remaining expense with Kit against the stated purposes. Mika would keep the record visible to contributors. Anything left would go back by the arrangement they had actually accepted. No surprise donation to my face.

I accepted that. The envelope stayed on their side of the table. Nigga, shared money had developed a location outside my pocket.

'Do they buy my dance?' I asked Shawna, attempting a recovery.

'No. I happen to want you. Don't make it accounting.'

Rae smiled at Nia. Nia smiled back, then turned toward the room. 'I also don't want our dance used as proof that the summit worked. I asked a woman I like to dance. That gets to be smaller than your campaign.'

I nodded. Porsche removed the planned photograph from the list without asking Nia to defend it.

Porsche asked what should happen if a recording continued after somebody said stop. Rae wanted it stopped, not debated over her head. Kit wanted a named person to take the request so the person objecting did not have to chase the whole room.

Mika took that job for the event. The photographer agreed to check a shot before using it and to set disputed material aside. If the plan broke, the recording would pause while the people involved decided the next step. An apology would not substitute for stopping the camera.

Nia approved the arrangement and declined the job of supervising it. She had a dance to attend. Porsche lowered her phone to show she had heard.

Remy sat on the arm of a chair. 'When people argue about whether men belong in a room, I hear the word differently from the way I did before transition. I still want friendships with women. I don't want my being a man treated as either a betrayal or a useful exception.'

June asked what he wanted tonight.

'My name used correctly. My number heard. My terrible fanfare tolerated once.'

'Once is a strong negotiating position,' Dez said.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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Velvet flicked his crown with one finger. 'He is still responsible for the pun. Coalition will not save him.'

I liked that. Responsibility could remain particular. Nobody had to defend an entire category before admitting one man's joke was bad.

Kit asked whether our agreement should include never offending each other. Rae said no. She wanted people to stop, listen and repair what they could when they did. She did not promise to become instantly comfortable because the apology sounded polished.

Kit accepted that without asking how long Rae's patience would last.

The corrected service sheet returned. Nia read it; Mika checked the contact details; Rae said it answered the practical question she had asked. June asked whether everybody could still decline a game without being asked to explain their mood.

That line was already there. We kept it.

Dez reached for the jacket on her chair. 'And can we finally settle the sleeve business?'

Dez said she would return the coat when they signed. Could she then borrow it for the walk downstairs? June said yes.

Fifty-nine years of comedy briefly reduced itself to a question that could have been asked over a jukebox. Neither woman looked diminished by the answer.

I looked at the portrait crate. No communal payment, no title granting me the last word, no proof that I had become a better man merely because the floor was expensive.

Shawna took my hand anyway.

'You staying?' I asked.

'For the signing. For the dance. For you, if you stop trying to invoice the feeling.'

I kissed her hand, paid the remaining real workers and helped Mika clear the path to the table.

Peace was not everybody agreeing that I meant well.

Tonight, it was a door that stayed open, a number somebody would answer, work somebody would pay for, and enough room for two women to choose a song without becoming my evidence.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P211 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Past Within

Edition considered: PC release; two devices required

Exchange clues across two separate perspectives in a Rusty Lake mystery, making describing what you see the central cooperative activity rather than sharing one controller.

What you do. Use separate devices to inspect scenes, describe symbols and objects, and combine information from the past and future to solve puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Both players need copies, devices and communication; eerie imagery and remembering described clues add demands, while exact input behavior remains unchecked.

Why it might click. Two players occupy different times and exchange information to solve a Rusty Lake mystery. Separate perspectives make describing, listening and comparing observations the actual cooperative activity rather than a decorative addition to a solo puzzle.

The full catch. This is co-op only: each player needs their own copy, a device and a way to communicate. Eerie imagery and puzzling symbols may be unwelcome. Reading, remembering descriptions and manipulating the interface still need checking; the premise does not establish a complete absence of timed or held actions.

Try this first. Set up both perspectives and exchange one precise observation before pursuing a solution. Try any unfamiliar interaction separately. Decide whether the pleasure comes from explaining what you see, and whether either person wants brief written notes.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P211 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Past Within

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Past Said Blue; the Future Said Burgundy

The Past Within gave June and Dez an immediate reason to dispute separate accounts of the same object. June remembered the jacket as blue. Dez remembered replacing its burgundy lining.

'Those are different parts,' Rae said. Both women paused, irritated by the possibility of a cheap solution.

Nia and Rae tried the game's separate perspectives, checking their own screens before describing what they saw. I hovered between them like an unsolicited weather report.

'Can I provide context?' I asked. 'You can provide a chair,' Nia said.

I brought one and sat in it, which was not quite what she meant. Shawna moved it back far enough that my knees stopped entering Rae's view.

The eerie mystery required communication, copies and devices, not simply two people staring at one display. Our coat mystery required noticing an inside and an outside.

Dez turned the lining out. June touched the blue sleeve. Both accounts survived.

I declared reconciliation. Rae asked me to wait until somebody had finished a sentence before installing the plaque.

Aiden's verdict. Try the two-perspective mystery when its setup and clue communication appeal. Our witnesses have discovered that a jacket can possess an outside without cancelling the evidence of its lining.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1515210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P212 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Kirby and the Forgotten Land

Edition considered: 2022 Nintendo Switch original; not Switch 2 Star-Crossed World edition

Explore colourful three-dimensional stages and rescue Waddle Dees, with a second player joining as Bandana Waddle Dee and a town developing between adventures.

What you do. Move through stages, use character abilities, fight enemies and explore together, trying the distinct Kirby and Bandana Waddle Dee roles.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Platforming and combat remain; timed Treasure Road challenges and held abilities are explicit, and the cooperative roles differ.

Why it might click. Explore three-dimensional stages, rescue Waddle Dees and develop a town between adventures. Original Switch local cooperation adds Bandana Waddle Dee beside Kirby. Nintendo's Spring-Breeze mode gives more health and easier enemies.

The full catch. This remains platforming and combat. Nintendo explicitly describes timed Treasure Road challenges and abilities involving held buttons, such as charging a hammer or aiming a bomb. The second role differs. The 2022 Switch original is assessed here, not the Switch 2 expansion or upgrade.

Try this first. Try the opening area in Spring-Breeze mode if desired, testing movement and each character's basic actions. Check whether both people like their role before pursuing a boss or time challenge. The official page lists a demo, whose current availability can be checked on the console.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P212 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Kirby and the Forgotten Land

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Kirby Was Not Available to Clear the Buffet

Kirby and the Forgotten Land made Tank ask whether the pink hero could help with the remaining buffet. Rosa told him the buffet already had sufficient heroic attention.

Remy wanted Kirby. Velvet wanted to know what the second character actually did before accepting a role described vaguely as also there.

Rae checked the different jobs with them. Nia watched the first trial while Mika cleared enough table space for both controllers.

I offered a magnificent introduction for Player Two. Velvet said she preferred actual information. Nigga, my ceremonial skill set was experiencing another small recession.

The game had real platforming, combat and timed challenges beyond its welcoming appearance. Remy liked the movement; Velvet wanted to switch roles once they understood them.

They did. Nothing about the exchange reduced either performer's billing.

Across the room, June took another pastry. Dez quietly moved the napkin closer. Tank observed that partnership could be measured in the distance between food and a clean sleeve.

Rosa kissed his cheek and handed him the empty tray.

Aiden’s verdict. Try the colourful adventure if both people like its active demands and understand the unequal roles. Player Two receives a proper explanation before any speech about shared greatness.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/kirby-and-the-forgotten-land-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P213 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Kirby's Return to Dream Land Deluxe

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch Deluxe edition

Share a colourful platform adventure with several character choices, helping rebuild a ship while abilities and a helper option offer different ways to participate together.

What you do. Choose characters, move through stages, float, jump and fight together while trying the main adventure's available assistance.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Active moves and platforming remain despite Helper Magolor; later modes and subgames have different demands from the opening adventure.

Why it might click. The Deluxe Switch platform adventure supports up to four local players, including different Kirbys and familiar companions. Repairing Magolor's ship gives the group a shared journey, while character abilities and separate subgames provide variety.

The full catch. Floating, fighting, jumps and different move sets remain active demands. Nintendo confirms Helper Magolor for the main adventure, but that does not erase every challenge. The later Magolor Epilogue must be unlocked and has its own action; do not treat all modes as equivalent.

Try this first. Use an early main-adventure section to test movement and a character's basic ability. Examine Helper Magolor if helpful. Leave competitive subgames and coordinated team attacks for later, and keep the first shared session free from a completion target.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P213 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Kirby's Return to Dream Land Deluxe

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ship Rebuilders Rejected My Figurehead

Kirby's Return to Dream Land Deluxe offered a ship to rebuild and several characters to choose. I suggested decorating the summit's signing table like a vessel and putting my head on the prow. Mika considered it for half a second. That was enough to frighten Shawna. 'No additional carpentry,' she said. 'The table works.'

Kit and Remy chose characters for a small trial. Kit wanted to understand the ordinary movement before looking at extra modes. Remy wanted to announce every successful action in his royal voice. Velvet asked whether he could announce one successful silence. He tried. We enjoyed it.

The game's assistance did not make its active platforming disappear. Nor would a carved head make our table easier to use. Rae checked the leg once, found it steady and went back to Nia.

I offered to demonstrate seaworthiness with a glass of water. Rosa removed the glass from my hand. The table remained a table. Nigga, occasionally an entire fleet must accept that destiny.

Aiden's verdict. Try the shared platform adventure if its movement suits, treating extra modes separately. The rebuilt signing table has declined a figurehead and will continue performing its excellent ordinary function.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

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Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/kirbys-return-to-dream-land-deluxe-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P214 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Super Mario Bros. Wonder

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

Discover playful changes in side-scrolling courses, with local multiplayer and character choices that can reduce enemy-damage concerns while keeping the platforming adventure active and surprising.

What you do. Run and jump through courses, try power-ups or character abilities, and help other players as unexpected Wonder effects change the surroundings.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Jumps, gaps and moving hazards remain; enemy-damage protection does not establish an easy, no-hold route through every course.

Why it might click. Side-scrolling courses change in imaginative ways when Wonder effects appear. Up to four local players can tackle them together. Nabbit and Yoshis avoid damage from enemies, and Yoshis can carry other players.

The full catch. Running, jumping, gaps, moving hazards and coordination remain part of an action game. Enemy-damage protection does not certify an effortless or no-hold path through every course. Character restrictions also matter: Nintendo says Nabbit and Yoshis do not transform with power-ups.

Try this first. Pick characters for their actual appeal and try one early course without collecting every optional item. Check movement and jump controls before introducing extra badges. A companion should match the agreed pace rather than racing ahead to demonstrate expertise.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P214 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Super Mario Bros. Wonder

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Wonder Effect Was My Wife Saying Yes

Super Mario Bros. Wonder made every unexpected change look like an invitation to react. Mika proposed a surprise at the signing. Shawna immediately asked whether it involved falling objects. 'Not falling,' Mika said. 'Descending with intention.'

I loved it. Rae asked for the ceiling plan. Nia asked why anyone needed a ceiling plan to sign a sheet of paper.

Kit chose a character and tested the movement. The available protection did not eliminate gaps or moving hazards; she wanted to see what her hands would actually do.

Remy cheered once, too loudly, then lowered his voice when she asked. A remarkably affordable adjustment.

Mika cancelled the descending decorations and saved one small lighting change for the music. I asked Shawna whether she would dance with me when it happened.

'Yes,' she said.

Nigga, that was the surprise I should have commissioned. Across the room, Rae heard Nia laughing at my expression and moved her chair closer.

The ceiling remained entirely loyal to the ceiling.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the surprising courses if their platforming fits the chosen players. Our ceremony's wonder effect is now a lighting change, with all ceiling decorations keeping their existing altitude.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

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Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/super-mario-bros-wonder-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P215 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Tick Tock: A Tale for Two

Edition considered: PC release; two-device format

Solve an eerie clockwork mystery through two separate screens, combining what each person can see and turning clear description into the main shared pleasure together.

What you do. Inspect your own scenes, describe clues and symbols, and use information from the other player's screen to solve linked puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Two players need separate devices and setup; clue communication can be demanding, and the clock imagery does not establish actual timer behavior.

Why it might click. Separate screens hold pieces of an eerie clockwork mystery, and two people combine what they see to escape. The developer describes cross-platform play, so communication rather than a shared physical controller is the central partnership.

The full catch. It requires two players and separate devices; check the exact copies and setup needed on the chosen platforms. Describing symbols and retaining another person's clues can be demanding. The clock imagery and promotional urgency do not establish the actual timer behavior; inspect it directly.

Try this first. Choose the two perspectives and compare one visible clue. Try describing shape, location and order before proposing a theory. Establish that asking for a repeat is ordinary cooperation, then see whether the eerie atmosphere adds pleasure or merely pressure.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P215 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Tick Tock: A Tale for Two

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Clock Had Two Faces and I Misread Both

Tick Tock's separate screens suited Nia and Rae until I volunteered to improve their descriptions. Nia said there was a clock. I called it a statement about history.

Rae waited. 'Does history have a number on it?'

Kit laughed into her sleeve. Nia ignored my contribution and described the thing she could actually see. Rae answered with a useful detail from her own side.

I turned toward the real clock above the bar and announced that we were almost ready for the signing. The clock was a decoration fixed at ten past ten.

June remembered the Blue Comet's clock doing the same thing. Dez said June had used it as an excuse for being late.

The game's clock imagery did not settle its actual timing behaviour. Our wall clock did not settle anything at all.

Mika checked the time on their phone and gave the performers a clear order. Remy had four minutes to locate his crown.

Velvet was wearing it. For once, the description needed no interpretation.

Aiden's verdict. Try the paired mystery if separate devices and careful descriptions appeal. Our symbolic clock has lost scheduling authority, and Remy's crown has been identified without a historical dissertation.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

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Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/790740/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P216 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Captain Toad: Treasure Tracker

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch version

Explore compact three-dimensional puzzle courses, turning the view to discover hidden routes, treasures and mechanisms, with Switch two-player support depending on the installed setup.

What you do. Move through small courses, rotate the view, inspect paths and treasures, and try the actual second-player role on the console.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Camera rotation, hazards and aiming remain; check the installed version's cooperative roles instead of assuming both players control identical characters.

Why it might click. Compact three-dimensional courses invite you to inspect routes, hidden items and mechanisms from different angles. The Switch release includes two-player support, making it a possible shared puzzle expedition once the actual roles and update level are clear.

The full catch. Camera rotation, hazards, aiming and some moving challenges remain relevant. Nintendo's current product text describes second-player turnip assistance and newer features separately; verify the installed version's cooperative roles rather than assuming identical control. This card excludes VR and separately sold extra stages.

Try this first. Explore an early course and rotate the view deliberately before moving near a hazard. Try the second-player role on the actual console. Ask whether discovering a route together feels satisfying and whether the camera is comfortable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P216 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Captain Toad: Treasure Tracker

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Captain Found the Pen from the Other Side

Captain Toad's little courses made Rae turn the signing table around to inspect the last troublesome corner. A cable ran directly beneath the chair where June wanted to sit.

I had inspected that table repeatedly from the side with my portrait. Apparently excellent branding did not provide complete visibility.

Rae moved the cable. Nia held the lamp. Mika discovered that the lamp's cord now reached without stretching across anyone's lap.

I announced a triumph of collaborative vision. 'You can lift that end,' Rae said. Nigga, the title arrived with a carrying assignment again.

The game's view rotation and differing two-player arrangements needed checking on the installed setup. Our room benefited from trying a second angle before declaring itself finished.

June sat and tested the space. Dez placed the coat over the back, where it did not drag on the floor.

Shawna found the missing pen beneath my unused speech. She handed it to Nia.

The treasure had been waiting under the one object nobody wanted to examine.

Aiden's verdict. Inspect the compact courses if rotating views and movement suit. Our signing table has passed inspection from a second angle, and the speech no longer conceals essential equipment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

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Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/captain-toad-treasure-tracker-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P217 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Yoshi's Crafted World

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

Explore a playful world made from everyday craft materials, sharing two-player movement and discovering new details when familiar stages are viewed from their reverse side.

What you do. Move and jump through stages, aim at objects, collect items and explore with another Yoshi, trying Mellow mode if desired.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Jumping, aiming and enemies remain despite Mellow wings; collecting everything can also add repeated travel and extra tasks.

Why it might click. Everyday craft materials become a playful landscape for two local Yoshis. Collecting objects and seeing stages from the reverse side can turn a familiar route into a fresh observation game. Mellow mode gives Yoshi wings.

The full catch. Jumping, aiming, enemies and movement still exist, and searching for every collectible can add repeated travel. Wings change part of the challenge; they do not prove every input is comfortable or every sequence untimed. Both players should test their controls rather than relying on the handmade appearance.

Try this first. Try an opening section, with Mellow mode if desired, and practise one jump and one aimed action. Enjoy the scenery without making complete collection a requirement. Let either player decide that looking together is more pleasant than controlling a character.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P217 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Yoshi's Crafted World

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Cardboard Palace Looked Better from Behind

Yoshi's Crafted World made Mika bring out a tiny hotel model built from leftover packaging. I admired its grand entrance until Rae turned it around.

The reverse side read ECONOMY COFFEE FILTERS. Kit said the architecture had finally admitted its budget.

I offered gold paint. Mika refused. They liked that the ordinary materials were still visible, and the model already looked better than the expensive centrepiece I had ordered.

Remy and Velvet tried the shared movement, discussing aiming and jumps without claiming the wings would settle every demand. Remy wanted to collect everything. Velvet wanted to see the next place first.

They chose one route for now. The rest could wait without becoming a dispute over who loved the game more.

Nia placed two tiny paper figures beside the model's door. Rae moved them toward its little dance floor.

I asked where my figure was. Shawna lifted a coffee-filter lid. 'In the private collection.'

Nigga, even in miniature I had secured an entirely unpaid annex.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the handmade stages if their active controls appeal and collecting stays enjoyable. Our cardboard hotel keeps its visible materials, while my miniature annex remains available by appointment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/yoshis-crafted-world-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P218 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Snipperclips - Cut it out, together!

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game; Plus expansion separate

Reshape paper characters together to interact with objects and solve inventive physical puzzles, finding humour in experiments that do something different from what you expected.

What you do. Move and rotate the characters, overlap their shapes, cut deliberately and work together to manipulate objects in cooperative puzzles.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Precise overlap, rotation and unstable objects can require repeated attempts; competitive and action-focused modes have different demands.

Why it might click. Partners reshape paper characters to interact with objects and solve physical puzzles. The Switch base game includes cooperative play; its competitive Blitz activities and larger Party challenges are distinct choices, not one uniform experience.

The full catch. Precise overlap, rotation, movement and manipulating unstable objects can take repeated attempts. Some modes are action-focused. The cheerful visual style does not establish no holds or no urgency, and the Plus expansion should not be assumed to be part of the base release.

Try this first. Begin with an ordinary cooperative puzzle, test how cutting and restoring a shape work, and agree before cutting the other character. See whether the shared experimentation is funny even when it fails. Leave competitive activities out of the initial trial.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P218 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Snipperclips - Cut it out, together!

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Paper Crown Became a Useful Hole

Snipperclips made Kit and Remy argue cheerfully about what shape would solve a shared problem. Remy wanted everything to resemble a crown. Kit wanted the next object to fit.

I understood both positions, having spent the evening wearing a title that did not fit through several doorways.

Velvet gave them a paper mock-up of her stage arch. Mika wanted the centre opened wider. Remy proposed more points along the top.

'The dress passes through the middle,' Velvet said. 'My invoice goes wherever it likes.'

They cut the middle. The model suddenly worked. Remy kept one point as a tiny crown for Mika's miniature hotel.

The game's precise overlap and unstable objects still required trial and coordination. Our paper arch required asking the person wearing the dress what she needed.

Nia offered Rae the scissors handle first. Rae took them, trimmed a rough edge and returned them with a smile.

I called it romance through craftsmanship. Shawna said I could start by cutting the label out of her coat.

Aiden's verdict. Try reshaping together if precision and repeated experiments feel playful. Our paper arch now accommodates its performer, while its spare crown has accepted a smaller and entirely decorative kingdom.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

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Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/snipperclips-cut-it-out-together-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P219 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Blanc

Edition considered: PC release

Help a wolf cub and fawn find their families through a hand-drawn snowy landscape, using their different strengths in a wordless cooperative journey together.

What you do. Guide the two animals through the environment, follow tracks and use their complementary abilities to get past shared obstacles.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Two buttons still involve positioning and coordination; separation, harsh weather and movement demands need checking despite the gentle artwork.

Why it might click. A wolf cub and a fawn travel through a hand-drawn black-and-white landscape, following their families' traces and using complementary abilities. The PC release supports local and online cooperation, with text-free storytelling.

The full catch. The developer describes two buttons plus movement, but a small button count does not settle coordination, precision, repetition or held movement. Navigation and obstacles still need both players. Separation and harsh weather give the gentle artwork an emotional edge.

Try this first. Move each animal through the opening space and try its first useful action. Check whether the viewpoint and character positions are easy to read together. Agree that either person can request a pause or a repeated explanation without apologising.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P219 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Blanc

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Snow Tracks Led to Dessert

Blanc's wolf cub and fawn made June remember walking home from the Blue Comet after a winter party. Dez said there had been no snow.

'There was frost,' June replied. 'On your windscreen. We took the bus.'

I offered to reconstruct the journey with a projection. Both women told me not to spend money proving either of them right.

Rae and Nia looked at the characters' different strengths and tried describing what each needed. Their route could be shared without every movement becoming an examination of the relationship.

The snowy game's separation and movement still mattered beneath its gentle art. Our old eyewitnesses had a gentler immediate problem: remembering which way the dessert table had moved.

Tank pointed it out. June offered Dez her arm. Dez took it while continuing to dispute the weather.

Shawna watched them go and leaned against me. I said lasting affection clearly required historical flexibility.

'It requires you to remember where I put my shoes,' she replied. I began with the present.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the snowy pair if complementary movement and coordination suit. Our witnesses may keep disputing the weather while sharing a perfectly visible route toward the last slice of cake.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1982340/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P220 / A PLACE TO START

Hidden Through Time

Edition considered: PC first game

Search lively illustrated scenes for hidden objects, using clues and small visual jokes to make patient shared observation feel like a succession of discoveries together.

What you do. Inspect hints, scan each scene, adjust the view and select hidden objects, with others welcome to look beside the player.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense scenes and small targets can be tiring; test zooming, panning and clicking, and do not assume native co-op.

Why it might click. Search colourful scenes for hidden objects across historical settings, using hints and visual detail. The PC game also offers a map editor and community creations, though the initial appeal can simply be one busy picture enjoyed together.

The full catch. Dense scenes, small objects and repeated scanning may be the main burden. Zooming, panning and clicking deserve direct checks; a hidden-object premise does not establish a complete no-timer or no-hold path. The inspected product lists single-player: shared looking is not verified native co-op.

Try this first. Open one ordinary scene and inspect a clue, a small object and the available view controls. Search without a race or a requirement to clear the whole picture. Ask whether the artwork makes looking pleasant before adding community maps.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P220 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Hidden Through Time

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hidden Object Was the Person Making the Speech

Hidden Through Time made me promise an easy search for the ceremonial pen. It was bright gold, larger than necessary and currently nowhere near the signing table.

Kit scanned the shelves. Remy checked his costume pockets. Mika inspected the miniature hotel because they had already hidden three useful things inside it.

Rae watched me explain the pen's importance. Then she pointed at my lapel.

There it was, clipped beside the flower I had ordered to make myself look approachable. Nigga, I had spent four minutes describing a missing object that was attending my speech.

Nia took it and tested the ink. June said the old Blue Comet agreement had failed because someone lost the pen. Dez said June kept it to do the crossword.

'It was a good pen,' June admitted.

The illustrated searches could be enjoyed beside one player without pretending that meant native cooperation. Our search ended with several witnesses and one embarrassed host.

Shawna unpinned the flower too. She said it was hiding my last remaining sense of proportion.

Aiden's verdict. Search together if dense scenes and small targets remain pleasant. Our signing pen has survived the host's lapel, and June has agreed to bring a separate crossword pen.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/524910/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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|----------------------|--------------------|---------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| Niggas, games up. | Niggas, pens out. | Niggas, chairs in. | Niggas, snacks here. | Niggas, receipts ready. |
| Niggas, lights on. | Niggas, mic check. | Niggas, take turns. | Niggas, dance later. | Niggas, read first. |
| Niggas, pick freely. | Niggas, no rush. | Niggas, sign here. | Niggas, stay petty. | Niggas, we're good. |

P221 / A PLACE TO START

Tiny Lands

Edition considered: PC first game

Compare miniature three-dimensional scenes without a time limit or mistake penalty, enjoying small visual discoveries while turning the view to inspect another angle together.

What you do. Rotate and zoom the scenes, compare details and select differences, taking as much time as the ordinary search needs.

Movement + camera | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Small visual differences and camera manipulation still need checking; the no-time-limit promise does not establish hold-free or drag-free input.

Why it might click. Rotate and compare miniature three-dimensional scenes to find their differences. The publisher explicitly states that there is no time limit and no penalty for mistakes, making patient shared observation a plausible way to enjoy it.

The full catch. The scenes still require visual discrimination, zooming and rotation. Check whether the actual camera manipulation uses uncomfortable holds or drags. The inspected description presents a single-player comparison game; shared looking is an informal arrangement, even though Remote Play Together appears among store features.

Try this first. Compare one pair of scenes at whatever pace feels pleasant. Rotate once, zoom once and make an uncertain selection to understand the feedback. Nobody needs to find every difference before deciding whether the artwork and observation suit the mood.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P221 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Tiny Lands

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Miniature Summit Contained One Fewer Ego

Tiny Lands suited Mika's collection of little hotels so closely that they accused me of choosing it to flatter them. I said I would never manipulate a colleague that cheaply.

Rae held up the catering bill. 'We believe you.'

Mika placed two versions of the model summit beside each other. Kit spotted a missing chair. Remy spotted a different curtain. Nia spotted that one portrait was considerably smaller.

I called that version inaccurate. Shawna called it promising.

The game's unhurried comparison still involved small differences and camera manipulation to test. Our tabletop version involved spotting which room left the most space for people to move.

June preferred the smaller portrait. Dez said it resembled the back of a postage stamp. I pointed out that stamps were historically important.

Rae moved the miniature signing table closer to the light. Nia shifted the paper dancers away from the door.

Neither model needed another improvement from me. Nigga, I had become the only difference still arguing with its own solution.

Aiden's verdict. Compare the little scenes if their visual details and camera controls suit. Our miniature summit chooses the smaller portrait and has declined a commemorative stamp explaining why I matter.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Tiny Lands Steam publisher description explicitly states no time limit and no punishment for mistakes, and describes adjustable angle and zoom. Single-player comparison is explicit; Remote Play Together is not treated as proof of native cooperative roles. Held/dragged camera input remains to check.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1354910/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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P222 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

PHOGS!

Edition considered: PC release

Guide two connected dog heads through playful physics puzzles, with stretching and grabbing turning different intentions into comic shared problem-solving across food, sleep and play worlds.

What you do. Move the two heads, grab objects, stretch and coordinate their actions to cross obstacles in the chosen cooperative setup.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Connected movement and grabbing can require precision or holds; test the controller arrangement before assuming shared-controller play is easiest.

Why it might click. Red and Blue stretch, grab and bounce through physics puzzles in food, sleep and play worlds. The PC release explicitly supports local and online co-op as well as single-player and shared-controller arrangements.

The full catch. Two connected heads create funny movement but also coordination demands. Grabbing, stretching, positioning and repeated physical attempts can matter more than the cheerful setting suggests. Check the chosen controller arrangement and any holds directly; shared-controller play is a separate configuration, not automatically the easiest one.

Try this first. Try moving toward one object together and agree which head will act first. Test grabbing and releasing before pursuing a larger challenge. Judge whether accidental entanglement feels playful or irritating, and adjust the partnership rather than blaming either person.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P222 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

PHOGS!

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Two Heads, One Very Unhelpful Destination

PHOGS! made Dre claim the blue side before I finished introducing the connected dog. Rae asked whether I knew where my own end planned to go.

'Toward success,' I said. 'Try the object,' she replied.

Dre wanted to inspect something nearby. I wanted to demonstrate leadership by stretching dramatically in another direction. Our intentions became visible immediately, which I found an unfair feature of shared effort.

'Nigga, tell me first,' Dre said, laughing.

We stopped and chose a small plan. The movement and grabbing still needed testing; our friendship did not automatically supply precise coordination.

Across the room, June and Dez lifted the old jacket together to show Nia the repaired lining. One held the collar, the other the hem. Somehow a garment with decades of disputed ownership proved easier to coordinate than me.

Shawna asked whether the two heads had reached a settlement. Dre said one of them had discovered speech.

I described my next move before making it. The room treated this modest development as a historic event.

Aiden's verdict. Try the connected dog if its grabbing and shared movement feel enjoyable. One head now announces its destination before attempting to drag the other into a victory speech.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/850320/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P223 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Pikuniku

Edition considered: PC release; co-op levels separate from solo story

Explore an absurdly cheerful world with a darker story underneath, or choose separate local cooperative levels for a shared dose of comic physical puzzles instead.

What you do. Move, jump and kick through the story's situations or work with another player in the distinct cooperative challenge levels.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. The solo campaign and co-op levels are different modes, and simple drawings do not remove active movement or timing demands.

Why it might click. A deliberately silly puzzle-exploration adventure pairs peculiar characters with a story about a deceptively cheerful dystopia. The separate local cooperative levels offer a different way to enjoy its physical comedy with another player.

The full catch. The story campaign is not the same as the dedicated co-op challenges. Movement, jumping, kicking and physical timing can require active coordination. Do not infer an untimed or hold-free experience from the simple drawings or the description's invitation to explore at your own pace.

Try this first. First decide whether the goal is shared story viewing or actual two-player puzzles. Try one short movement section in that mode and see whether the comic physics are enjoyable. Leave progress targets aside while testing the basic legwork.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, we're good.

P223 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Pikuniku

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Revolution Had Separate Cooperative Levels

Pikuniku's bright absurdity tempted Remy to declare the overthrow of boring ceremonies. Velvet supported the movement until he proposed opening her performance with three new puns. 'The revolution has already betrayed me,' she said. I offered to mediate from the gold chair. Rae asked why every rebellion somehow supplied me with better furniture. The game's solo story and separate cooperative levels gave us a useful practical distinction. Kit wanted to inspect the shared challenges; Mika wanted to see the strange world another time. Nobody needed to turn those wishes into a contest for the correct way to enjoy it. Remy and Kit tried the movement while Velvet reviewed her own music. June announced that the Blue Comet's first rebellion had concerned a jukebox button that swallowed coins. Dez said it concerned June's refusal to admit she had pressed the wrong song. Both accounts produced excellent arguments. Neither required my chair. Shawna put the chair behind the signing table. At last, my throne had joined the furniture service. **Aiden's verdict.** Explore the comic movement if it appeals, choosing deliberately between story and separate co-op levels. Our revolution has retained the singer's song and reassigned the host's throne.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026. Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/572890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P224 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Overboard!

Edition considered: PC release

Play the culprit in a replayable shipboard mystery, using conversations and manipulation to change what other characters believe before the journey reaches its destination.

What you do. Choose where to go, question or mislead characters, and track what people have seen as you construct a possible cover story.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The eight-hour story schedule creates pressure; reading, character movements and replay matter, while exact real-time clock behavior needs checking.

Why it might click. You play the culprit on a 1930s liner and try to escape justice through conversations, lies and manipulation. Characters remember events and move independently, making a replayed situation reveal new possibilities. A companion can discuss schemes beside the single-player screen.

The full catch. The story gives you eight in-game hours, with schedules and missed opportunities creating pressure. The inspected description does not resolve every real-time or pause detail, so test how the clock advances. Reading, remembering movements and replaying failed plans are central burdens.

Try this first. Inspect the first choices and clock behavior before pursuing an elaborate cover story. Discuss one possible explanation only if the player wants advice. Decide whether mischievous replay and moral inversion feel entertaining rather than exhausting.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P224 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Overboard!

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Alibi Had Been Photographed from Three Angles

Overboard!'s culprit-led mystery made me think about the missing portrait reimbursement clause. I suggested somebody must have removed it while I was attending to the guests.

Nia asked whether I had ever submitted it. 'Spiritually,' I said. Rae started laughing before the sentence finished.

Porsche had photographs of me posing beside the portrait during the relevant period. Mika had the original quote, addressed personally to me. Shawna had the message in which I called it my gift to history.

Tank said history should answer its phone.

The fictional shipboard cover-up required tracking what people knew. Mine collapsed because everyone knew exactly which nigga had ordered a face taller than the lift.

Velvet offered to make an announcement praising my personal generosity. I accepted, then realised that wording made reimbursement even less likely.

Nia left the clause out. Rae brought her a clean pen.

Shawna squeezed my hand. 'You can still enjoy the portrait.' 'Can you?' 'From a manageable distance,' she said.

Aiden's verdict. Try the culprit's conversations if schedules and remembered details sound entertaining. My reimbursement alibi has sunk beneath three photographs and the regrettably clear wording of my own message.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1546920/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P225 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Expelled!

Edition considered: PC release

Navigate a devious boarding-school mystery through gossip and remembered actions, trying to change the outcome of an accusation before the school day is over.

What you do. Talk to characters, investigate secrets, choose where to go and use information to alter how the accusation develops.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. One school day limits opportunities, and replay needs route memory; the official clock language does not establish every paused-screen behavior.

Why it might click. Verity Amersham navigates a 1922 boarding school after being accused of attempted murder. Conversations, secrets and manipulation reshape the day, offering a replayable narrative puzzle that can invite lively discussion from an optional companion.

The full catch. One school day limits the investigation, and characters act on what they witness. The official description's ticking-clock language establishes schedule pressure, not a verified rule for every paused screen. Expect reading, route memory and potentially unpleasant choices; it remains a single-player game.

Try this first. Inspect the opening accusation and the timetable or clock as presented. Try one conversation and observe the consequence of an action before designing a perfect route. Let curiosity about the characters decide whether another run sounds worthwhile.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P225 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Expelled!

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Summit Expelled My Reference Letter

Expelled!'s accusation-driven school day prompted me to draft a character reference for myself before anybody reviewed the final bill. I wrote dependable, visionary and financially misunderstood. Rae read it once. 'You forgot tall.' 'I'm concentrating on moral qualities.' 'That would explain the empty space.'

Nia refused to countersign a reference presented as evidence for the portrait. She did offer to correct the spelling of indispensable, which I found unnecessarily intimate.

Remy proposed a mock trial. Velvet wanted to play the prosecutor until Mika reminded them both that the actual show started soon.

The game's gossip, routes and remembered actions could remain inside its fictional school. Our adults already possessed enough receipts to settle this smaller case.

June offered to sign my reference if I carried her tea. Dez said that was precisely how the original coat testimony had become unreliable.

I brought tea anyway. Shawna wrote one truthful sentence beneath my grand claims: He eventually gets the cups right.

Nigga, I kept that recommendation.

Aiden's verdict. Enter the scheming school mystery if its limited day and route memory appeal. My reference survives as one accurate sentence, with visionary temporarily removed pending independent evidence.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2963890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P226 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Machinarium

Edition considered: PC release

Help a small robot through a hand-drawn mechanical city, reading gestures and solving puzzles as he works toward people he cares about along the way.

What you do. Inspect scenes, interact with objects, solve logical puzzles and use visual thought bubbles to understand the robot's problems.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Small targets, inventory logic and minigames can be demanding; wordless storytelling does not establish obvious solutions or entirely untimed play.

Why it might click. Guide a small robot through a hand-drawn mechanical city, solving logical puzzles and helping people he cares about. Animated thought bubbles replace long spoken conversations, giving a companion plenty to observe without requiring two playable characters.

The full catch. Inventory logic, small targets, brain teasers and minigames can become demanding. Wordless presentation does not mean obvious solutions or zero timing. Check the chosen PC interface and any puzzle assistance directly; the inspected source does not certify a fully untimed completion path.

Try this first. Explore the opening scene and try one object interaction. Ask whether the drawings and character gestures are appealing even before solving anything. Share a single suggestion only when requested, allowing the player to keep the satisfying discovery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P226 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Machinarium

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Little Robot Found My Missing Screw

Machinarium's small robot made Rae inspect the signing lamp with renewed suspicion. It leaned whenever somebody touched the table. I said the angle gave it character.

'It gives it a loose screw,' she replied.

Nia held the lamp steady while Rae found the problem. I offered to document the repair for the summit archive. Rae asked me to hold the shade instead.

That turned out to be an excellent job for someone with my particular combination of reach and opinions.

The game's visual gestures and mechanical puzzles still required patient interpretation. Our lamp gave a simpler clue: the base wobbled exactly where Rae had said.

She tightened it, Nia switched it on, and the page became easier to read. June said the Blue Comet had needed someone like Rae in 1967. Dez said it had needed someone to stop June moving the lamps.

Shawna stepped beneath the shade I was still holding. 'Finished, baby.'

I put it down. The lamp stood upright without being told who had made the evening possible.

Aiden's verdict. Meet the robot if visual puzzles and small interactions appeal. Our lamp now stands straight, and the repair record accurately credits the woman who located the screw.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/40700/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P227 / A PLACE TO START

Botanacula

Edition considered: PC release

Follow five little tree creatures through a world of peculiar inhabitants, music and playful reactions as they try to protect the last seed of their home.

What you do. Explore scenes, click on creatures and objects, interpret their reactions and try unusual combinations to solve the group's problems.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Minimal text shifts work toward visual interpretation and hotspots; some tasks may need precision or repeated attempts despite relaxed marketing.

Why it might click. Five tree creatures travel to protect the last seed of their home from parasites. The attraction is discovery: peculiar inhabitants, playful animations and inventive sound turn looking and clicking into a sequence of small surprises.

The full catch. Minimal text shifts the work toward interpreting visual behaviour, finding hotspots and inferring unusual puzzle rules. Some tasks may need precision or repeated attempts; the publisher's broad relaxed-play language is not a whole-game input audit. Shared observation remains distinct from native cooperative control.

Try this first. Explore a small area and interact with several visible creatures without trying to clear everything. Check the pointing demands and whether the nonverbal clues feel inviting. A companion can enjoy the reactions without supplying a running solution commentary.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P227 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Botanicula

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Five Creatures and One Uninvited Chairman

Botanicula's five little tree creatures made Mika arrange five miniature figures around their model hotel. I added a sixth, representing the host in a commanding pose.

Velvet turned it sideways. 'This one looks like it fell over.' 'It's addressing the assembly.' 'From the carpet?'

Rosa liked the little creatures' shared purpose. Tank liked the odd reactions. They watched an interaction together without demanding a formal plan for the entire adventure.

Nia noticed Mika had made one paper figure with a tiny crooked signature. Rae had supplied the drawing. Nia pretended to object, then moved the figure beside Rae's.

The game's minimal text left expressions and unusual responses to interpret. Our sixth figure had a clear problem: I had made its hat too heavy for its feet.

June propped it against the model wall. Dez said she had been doing something similar with June's arguments since the Blue Comet days.

Shawna saved my figure from another fall. 'No podium,' she advised. 'Start with balance.'

Aiden's verdict. Explore the peculiar creatures if visual interpretation and experimentation suit. Our sixth figure remains welcome after removing the oversized hat that prevented it from standing beside anybody else.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/207690/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P228 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Samorost 3

Edition considered: PC release

Explore alien worlds through a space gnome's curiosity, with a magical flute, unusual creatures and music making unfamiliar places inviting to investigate and understand.

What you do. Inspect scenes, listen to sounds, try object interactions and follow visual or musical patterns through the exploration puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Unusual puzzle logic, audio information and small hotspots need checking; the exploration premise does not certify no timers or dragging.

Why it might click. A space gnome follows the mystery of a magical flute through alien worlds full of creatures, images and music. The pleasure can lie in interpreting an unfamiliar place together, with one person operating the adventure and another noticing details.

The full catch. Sound and visual patterns matter to the experience, and some puzzle logic is deliberately strange. Check any audio-dependent clue, hotspot size and object manipulation directly. The inspected description supports exploration and puzzles, not a guarantee of no timers, no dragging or easy completion.

Try this first. Visit the opening area, listen at a comfortable volume and try a few visible interactions. Decide whether uncertainty feels intriguing or obstructive. Invite a companion to describe one noticed detail without immediately searching for an external solution.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P228 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Samorost 3

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Space Gnome Declined My Brass Section

Samorost 3's strange music gave Mercedes a reason to hush the room. She wanted to hear a sound again. I mistook the pause for an opening and offered a theory.

Porsche covered my mouth with the folded programme. Gently. Efficiently. A technique the summit should probably have discovered sooner.

Remy listened, then tried imitating the sound. It came out like an apologetic kettle. Kit supplied a second note and made it worse on purpose.

Mercedes laughed. Her original question survived the joke; she listened again without the rest of us performing an answer.

The space gnome's unfamiliar worlds invited looking and hearing, but their puzzle logic and interactions still needed checking. We had enough curiosity without promising effortless progress.

June said the Blue Comet jukebox once made exactly Remy's noise. Dez said that was because June selected a damaged record for six consecutive weeks.

I asked whether my commissioned brass recording would be welcome now. Shawna lifted the programme from Porsche's hand and returned it to its previous position.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the strange musical worlds if sound and observation appeal. Our brass section remains unplayed while Mercedes hears the actual note and the programme fulfils an unexpected acoustic purpose.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/421120/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P229 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

LEGO City Undercover

Edition considered: 2017 PC release; not original Wii U edition

Explore a large comic LEGO city together in the 2017 PC release, using disguises, vehicles and story missions to turn different neighbourhoods into shared adventures.

What you do. Walk and drive around the city, change roles, investigate objectives, fight and explore collectibles with another player.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Camera control, driving and action create broad demands; check split-screen legibility and controller setup before committing to the city.

Why it might click. Chase McCain pursues a criminal through a large LEGO city, using disguises, vehicles and comic situations. The 2017 PC release explicitly supports two-player cooperation, so companions can participate in the city rather than only watch its story.

The full catch. Open-world navigation, camera control, driving, fights, jumping and collecting create a broad action workload. A familiar toy aesthetic does not simplify every task. Check split-screen legibility and each controller setup before assuming the shared view works comfortably.

Try this first. Try walking, looking around and one simple objective together before driving fast or chasing collectibles. Agree on a meeting place and whether exploration or story is the purpose. Stop when the city's activity becomes more busy than amusing.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P229 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

LEGO City Undercover

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Undercover Host Wore His Own Name

LEGO City Undercover made me propose attending the signing incognito to discover what people really thought. I put on sunglasses beneath my name badge.

Rae looked up. 'Excellent disguise, Aiden.'

Remy offered me a false moustache from his case. Velvet refused on behalf of costume integrity. Apparently some crimes against theatre remained outside the coalition's forgiving spirit.

The comic city's disguises and vehicles promised a broad shared adventure, with camera and action demands to inspect. Our floor offered a shorter investigation: why was the photographer standing behind a potted palm?

Porsche said she had asked him to stop interrupting Nia and Rae for staged candids. He was now trying to photograph the coat instead.

June held it up. Dez adjusted the collar. For once they agreed about its presentation.

I removed the sunglasses and asked if they wanted a picture together. They said yes.

Shawna straightened my badge as I stepped aside. 'There. You finally used the correct identity: helpful host.'

Aiden's verdict. Roam the comic city if both players welcome its broad action demands. Our undercover operation has ended in an ordinary requested photograph, with the host correctly outside the frame.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/578330/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P230 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

LEGO Star Wars: The Skywalker Saga

Edition considered: PC base game

Share familiar film adventures through LEGO humour, with many characters and places to explore across a large local cooperative action game covering the Skywalker films.

What you do. Move and aim through story scenes, fight, use vehicles and switch character abilities while exploring together in local cooperative play.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Combat, camera movement, vehicles and character menus add work; the large scope and split-screen controls need a modest first trial.

Why it might click. The nine Skywalker films become a large comic action adventure with local cooperative play. Familiar scenes, many characters and places to explore can make a lively shared journey for people who already enjoy the setting.

The full catch. Combat includes aiming and attack combinations, and the game adds vehicles, camera movement, character abilities and extensive menus. The large scope can overwhelm a simple evening plan. Split-screen comfort and both players' controls need checking; brand familiarity does not remove those demands.

Try this first. Choose one starting trilogy and test a small opening section together. Try looking, moving, attacking and selecting a character without pursuing every collectible. Decide whether the shared jokes justify the action load before treating the whole saga as a commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, we're good.

P230 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

LEGO Star Wars: The Skywalker Saga

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Coalition Did Not Require a Galactic Emperor

The Skywalker Saga made Remy enter behind Velvet while humming the least triumphant part of his fanfare. She turned, cape sweeping, and told him the empire could wait until after her shoes were fastened.

I admired their scale. Nia admired the clear floor space beyond the cape. Rae inspected the route to the signing table one last time.

The game's many characters and local cooperative action needed a modest first trial. Our ceremony needed the same restraint, which I expressed by proposing a tiny throne.

'How tiny?' Shawna asked. Mika held up the model hotel chair. I decided the joke had become unreasonably organised.

June and Dez each chose a song for the jukebox after the signatures. Neither chose the song the other expected. Their original quarrel suddenly had an unfamiliar future.

Velvet fastened the shoe herself and offered Remy her arm. His fanfare finally sounded pleased.

I took Shawna's hand. Nigga, there were enough interesting people entering this room without appointing a galactic emperor.

Aiden's verdict. Share a small galactic outing if its action and control demands suit. Our ceremony now has two requested songs and no throne larger than Mika's miniature hotel furniture.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/920210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P231 / A PLACE TO START

LEGO Builder's Journey

Edition considered: PC release; Creative mode separate

Arrange small LEGO scenes through atmospheric geometric puzzles, or explore the separate Creative Mode when making a little construction is more appealing than following the narrative.

What you do. Select, rotate and place pieces, adjust the view, and either solve a small scene or build a model in Creative Mode.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Precise placement and camera control may involve holds or drags; shared design discussion does not establish native cooperative play.

Why it might click. Small geometric LEGO puzzles tell an atmospheric story through placed pieces and changing situations. The PC release separately includes Creative Mode for free construction and photographs, offering another route when arranging objects is more appealing than solving the narrative.

The full catch. Selecting, rotating, positioning and viewing small pieces may require precision. A quiet presentation does not prove every placement avoids holds or dragging. This is single-player; discussing designs beside someone is optional shared activity, not verified native cooperative control.

Try this first. Try one simple placement and rotate the view before choosing a longer puzzle. Alternatively, inspect Creative Mode and make a tiny scene. Let the person's interest in solving or building determine the mode instead of insisting on story progress.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P231 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

LEGO Builder's Journey

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Small Bridge Cost Less Than My Speech

LEGO Builder's Journey gave Mika an excuse to place a tiny bridge between the two halves of their model. I wanted an arch large enough to carry the summit title.

Rae asked what the bridge connected. 'People,' I said. 'Which two bits of the model?'

I pointed. One was the loading dock.

Nia and Rae tried arranging a small scene together, keeping clear that discussing a build did not magically provide a native second-player role. Mika watched the pieces with obvious pleasure.

I finally understood that a little construction could be complete without becoming a monument. This revelation arrived several invoices too late, but Shawna seemed prepared to enjoy it anyway.

June moved the paper jacket from one miniature chair to another. Dez put the two chairs side by side. Their revised historical model required no triumphal arch.

Remy placed his spare paper crown on the loading dock. Velvet approved its new jurisdiction.

I left the bridge alone. Nigga, it successfully crossed the gap without quoting my opening remarks.

Aiden's verdict. Build or solve if small arrangements and their controls appeal, keeping shared discussion distinct from co-op. Our bridge reaches the other side without carrying a monument to its sponsor.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1544360/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P232 / A PLACE TO START

The Gardens Between

Edition considered: PC release

Manipulate time through dreamlike islands built from two friends' memories, discovering how familiar objects connect without text, speech or pressure to finish quickly.

What you do. Move time forward and backward, watch how objects interact and adjust the sequence to help the friends progress through each island.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Sequence puzzles still need attention, and moving time may require sustained input; simple controls do not establish no holds.

Why it might click. Manipulate time through dreamlike island scenes built from two friends' memories. The publisher explicitly describes a single-player game with no text, speech or time pressure, giving shared observation room to focus on images and sequences.

The full catch. You control the flow of time rather than simply steering each friend independently. Understanding cause and sequence can still be demanding, and sustained input to move time needs a direct check. Simple controls do not automatically mean no holds. This is shared thinking beside one player, not native co-op.

Try this first. Move time forward and back in the opening scene, noticing one object that changes or interacts differently. Check how the input feels before pursuing a long sequence. Decide whether the visual friendship story gives the puzzle enough emotional interest.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P232 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Gardens Between

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Garden Remembered the Song Differently

The Gardens Between's islands of memory made June hum a piece of the old club's jukebox song. Dez supplied the next line with complete confidence and entirely different words.

Mercedes knew the recording. She let them finish before revealing that both had invented a verse.

'It was loud in there,' June said. 'You were loud in there,' Dez replied.

The game let a sequence be reconsidered through moving time. Our women reconsidered one small piece of their story without losing the evening it belonged to.

Rae asked Nia what she would remember from tonight. Nia said the terrible invitation, the good coffee and Rae fixing a chair as though kindness could disguise itself as maintenance.

Rae kissed her cheek. I looked away just late enough for Shawna to notice me doing it theatrically.

'Nobody requested a privacy curtain made of your forehead,' she whispered.

I faced the screen. The remembered song continued behind me, beautifully wrong. For once, the room had no need of a definitive edition.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the memory puzzles if their sequences and sustained-input demands suit. June and Dez may keep their invented verse; the summit is not commissioning a corrected soundtrack.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher description explicitly calls The Gardens Between single-player and states no text, speech, time pressure or complex UI. Time manipulation, friendship and island puzzles are supported. The card retains uncertainty about sustained input and does not equate simple controls with no holds.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/600990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P233 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Day of the Tentacle Remastered

Edition considered: PC Remastered edition

Solve a comic adventure across three time periods, using changes in one era to create possibilities for another while following three unlikely friends and a tentacle's ambition.

What you do. Explore rooms, collect and use objects, switch characters and connect consequences between the different periods of the story.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Character switching, inventories and cross-era consequences create heavy tracking, and cartoon logic may feel inventive or frustrating.

Why it might click. A cartoon adventure links three protagonists across time, turning changes in one era into possibilities in another. The Remastered edition offers revised art and audio alongside classic presentation options, with comedy built into the puzzle logic.

The full catch. Inventories, character switching and consequences across different periods create a real memory burden. Cartoon logic may feel inventive or arbitrary. The source does not establish every timing or hold demand; preview the interface and selected presentation rather than assuming a classic adventure is automatically easy.

Try this first. Explore an early room and identify one useful object or conversation. Try switching the presentation if you prefer, then decide whether the humour and inventory handling appeal. A companion can keep one current question visible without delivering the whole solution.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P233 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Day of the Tentacle Remastered

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Tentacle Could Have Kept the Original Minutes

Day of the Tentacle's cross-era consequences made me wonder whether we could send someone back to the Blue Comet and prevent the entire coat dispute.

June said we could start by telling Dez to bring a hanger. Dez said we could start by telling June not to deliver a lecture with every borrowed sleeve.

Nia asked whether either wanted the actual years erased. Both women said no before I finished imagining the budget.

The game's three periods required tracking objects and consequences. Our own past required less equipment: a coat on the table, two surviving memories and room for neither to win every detail.

Rae suggested signing the useful parts now. Jukebox choices for everyone. Borrowing by asking. No compulsory games. No host portrait reimbursement.

'One of those came from the future,' I said. Shawna smiled. 'A brighter one.'

Remy checked the pens. Velvet checked the performance order. Mika opened the curtains around the table.

The tentacle could keep its ambition. Mine sat down and made space for two signatures.

Aiden's verdict. Travel through the comic time puzzles if their tracking feels enjoyable. Our past remains imperfect, while the present has acquired a practical agreement and an unmistakably personal portrait bill.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/388210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P234 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Trine Enchanted Edition

Edition considered: PC Enchanted Edition

Combine a wizard, knight and thief's different abilities in a fantasy adventure, using physical puzzles and cooperative action to find more than one way forward.

What you do. Move through stages, create or manipulate objects, fight and use character-specific abilities while coordinating with local or online partners.

Mixed controls | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Platforming, aiming and combat remain; character roles differ, and difficulty or saving features do not establish a no-reflex route.

Why it might click. Wizard, knight and thief combine different abilities in a fantasy world of physical puzzles and combat. Enchanted Edition supports up to three players locally or online, and the original 2009 release is also included as a separate launcher choice.

The full catch. Platforming, fighting, aiming and grappling remain active demands, with different burdens by character. The inspected description declares saving options and the store lists adjustable difficulty, but neither establishes a no-reflex or no-hold path. Choose Enchanted Edition deliberately rather than mixing its features with the original.

Try this first. In an early section, try each preferred character's movement and one ability. Discuss whether roles feel satisfying before combining them under pressure. A companion should not become the compulsory combat department unless that is genuinely the role they want.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P234 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Trine Enchanted Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Wizard Summoned a Stool Nobody Needed

Trine's different heroes made Remy claim the wizard's role in the ceremony. He produced a collapsible stool from behind the curtain. Velvet asked why. 'I anticipated an obstacle,' he said. 'You've supplied one,' she replied. Rae folded it and placed it against the wall. Nia needed room for her chair, not a demonstration of equipment. The game's character abilities could offer different ways through physical puzzles, but platforming and combat still mattered. Our ceremony had simpler jobs: keep the path clear, read the agreed wording and let the signers reach the pens. I volunteered to be the knight. Tank handed me the door to hold. Nigga, my chivalry continued to take a surprisingly architectural form. Kit chose the music cue. Mercedes checked the first note. Porsche put both phones away long enough to look at the room directly. June and Dez approached together, the jacket carried between them. Remy bowed without producing anything else. Velvet patted his shoulder. His best magic trick was restraint. **Aiden's verdict.** Try the fantasy action if its different roles and active demands suit. Our ceremonial wizard has returned the unnecessary stool, leaving a clear route for people with actual jobs.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/35700/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P235 / A PLACE TO START

Pilgrims

Edition considered: PC digital game; not the board game

Experiment with characters and objects in an illustrated adventure that welcomes different solutions, turning unexpected reactions and short comic situations into much of the pleasure.

What you do. Explore situations, choose items or characters to try, and watch how their combinations change a small story or solve a task.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Unusual responses still need interpretation, and item or card manipulation may involve dragging or holds that should be checked.

Why it might click. A playful illustrated adventure encourages trying items and characters in different situations, with multiple solutions rather than one fixed route through every task. Its brief, expressive reactions can be enjoyable to discover with someone watching beside you.

The full catch. Interpreting unusual responses and managing available objects still requires attention. Test how cards or items are selected and moved; do not assume that a playful interface avoids dragging or held actions. The inspected publisher description presents single-player experimentation, not verified native cooperative control.

Try this first. Try a couple of early combinations and watch what happens without demanding immediate progress. Check whether manipulating the items feels comfortable. A companion can suggest an experiment, but the person playing gets to choose which curiosity to follow.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P235 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Pilgrims

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Pilgrims Brought the Wrong Gift and Stayed Anyway

Pilgrims' experiments made me propose three possible ceremonial gifts: the gold pen, the miniature hotel or a voucher for a photograph beside my portrait.

Rae rejected the last one before I finished saying complimentary.

Mika kept the hotel. Nia wanted the pen to remain available for its stated purpose. June asked whether anyone had a decent biscuit.

Rosa produced a plate. The summit's gift policy solved itself without selecting from my elaborate options.

The game's odd combinations and reactions could be enjoyed as discoveries. Our guests were good at similar surprises: Remy offered Dez his tiny paper crown; she used it to prop up her biscuit napkin.

Velvet admired the transformation. Kit asked whether the crown now governed refreshments. Remy said it was his most successful reign.

I offered Shawna the photography voucher privately. She wrote something on the back and handed it to me.

It was a promise to dance after the signing. Nigga, at last an experimental combination had produced a result better than the object I started with.

Aiden's verdict. Experiment with the little adventure if its unusual responses and gestures appeal. The ceremonial gifts have found useful owners, and my portrait voucher now contains a much better offer.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1049280/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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P236 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Longest Journey

Edition considered: Original PC release

Spend time with April Ryan's journey between parallel universes, following conversations and puzzles through a large imaginative world that can be shared as a story.

What you do. Explore locations, speak with people, examine objects and solve inventory puzzles while following April's changing understanding of the two worlds.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The older PC release needs readability and compatibility checks; long conversations, repeated travel and inventory puzzles add substantial work.

Why it might click. April Ryan moves between parallel universes in a substantial original PC adventure filled with conversations, places and puzzles. Its appeal is spending time with a large imaginative world; another person can share the story and discuss clues beside the player.

The full catch. This older PC release needs a compatibility and readability check on the actual machine. Long dialogue, inventory puzzles, repeated travel and remembering multiple locations add work. Do not infer no timers, no holds or modern interface options from its age or genre.

Try this first. Launch the exact original release, inspect text and save behavior, then hear an opening conversation and try an object interaction. Decide whether the people and world justify the interface effort before treating the title as a promise to finish a very long journey.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P236 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Longest Journey

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Longest Journey Was Across My Own Convention Floor

The Longest Journey made April's passage between worlds sound easier than getting our entire party from the buffet to the signing table.

Velvet had one shoe off. Kit was halfway through a story. Remy was looking for his microphone, which Tank held while Rosa adjusted its stand.

I called for everyone to assemble. Nobody heard because I used the unplugged display microphone I had purchased for photographs.

Rae walked over and asked, in an ordinary voice, whether people were ready. The room began moving.

The older adventure's long conversations and inventory puzzles deserved their own trial. Our present journey needed no additional object beyond the working microphone already in Tank's hand.

June waited for Dez to finish her tea. Nia waited for Rae to put down the plate she was carrying. Shawna waited for me to stop testing the dead microphone.

Then we crossed the room together.

Nigga, two universes may require a heroine, but fifteen feet of carpet occasionally require admitting that your props do not function.

Aiden's verdict. Visit April's older adventure if its people justify the interface and puzzle work. Our own longest journey has ended at the signing table with one properly connected microphone.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/6310/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P237 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Broken Age

Edition considered: PC complete two-act release

Follow two teenagers in very different worlds as they question the lives arranged for them, with expressive characters, voice performances and puzzles linking the adventure.

What you do. Switch between the protagonists, explore their scenes, speak with characters and use objects to solve the developing puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Two threads and later inventory reasoning add heavy tracking; an approachable opening does not establish simple puzzles throughout.

Why it might click. Vella and Shay navigate very different worlds while trying to take control of their lives. The complete two-act point-and-click adventure combines hand-drawn scenes, voice performances, odd characters and puzzles, with switching between the protagonists part of the structure.

The full catch. Two story threads and inventory reasoning can require remembering details across scenes. Later puzzle complexity should not be inferred from an approachable opening. The developer page supports the premise and point-and-click form, not a full no-timer or no-hold certification. This is shared viewing of a single-player adventure.

Try this first. Hear an opening conversation, try one interaction and look at the character-switching interface. Choose which story to follow by interest. A companion can remember an earlier clue without taking over every decision or explaining a solution before it is wanted.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P237 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Broken Age

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Two Stories Declined One Grand Explanation

Broken Age's two protagonists resisting arranged lives made me offer a unifying interpretation of June and Dez's long dispute. Both women looked immediately suspicious.

'You loved the same club,' I began. 'We know,' June said. 'We were there,' Dez added.

Nia asked whether they wanted separate final statements or a shared one. June wanted to keep her version of the jacket. Dez wanted to keep hers. They both wanted the music available to everyone.

That was enough for a sentence.

The game's linked stories could ask us to follow two threads without pretending they began in the same place. Our agreement could do something smaller and equally useful: settle what happened next.

I put away the explanation I had prepared about generations and healing. Shawna touched my arm. 'You can just witness it.'

Rae passed June the pen. Nia steadied the page. Dez watched the first signature appear.

Nobody's whole life had been solved. One piece of paper had finally become worth signing.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the two-world story if its later puzzle tracking appeals. Our witnesses may keep different accounts while signing the same practical sentence about what happens next.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.doublefine.com/games/broken-age>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P238 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Dinkum

Edition considered: PC release; current version status must be checked

Build a town and explore an Australian-inspired landscape with friends, choosing whether default survival or the separate Creative Mode better suits the appeal of making a place.

What you do. Gather resources, farm, build and meet residents, or inspect Creative Mode before deciding which shared town activities to pursue.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Default play includes wildlife and combat; camera comfort, visitor permissions and some host-only town tasks still need checking.

Why it might click. Explore, gather, farm and build a settlement in an Australian-inspired landscape, meeting residents and inviting friends online. The full PC release combines town creation with survival and also includes a separate Creative Mode, offering a different focus for building.

The full catch. Default play includes wild animals, tools, combat, gathering, crafting and a three-dimensional view. Creative Mode changes building options, not the need to check camera comfort. Official launch notes leave some town quests to the host. Record the installed version rather than relying on old Early Access advice.

Try this first. Try walking, looking around and one modest town task before entering dangerous terrain. Inspect Creative Mode if building is the attraction, then check the chosen multiplayer permissions. Ask whether both players enjoy their available tasks rather than assigning one all the work.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P238 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Dinkum

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Town Host Needed Permission Too

Dinkum's shared town plans made Mika ask who would control the summit's remaining decorations after tonight. I answered as though ownership were an atmospheric quality surrounding my jacket. Rae asked who had actually built the useful pieces. Mika raised a hand. Kit raised one. Remy lifted the repaired arch. Velvet pointed at the light she had helped position.

Nia wrote that people could take their own contributions home, borrow by asking and leave unwanted ornaments for the person who bought them.

Everybody looked at me. Nigga, the portrait had become an unusually specific weather front.

The game's modes and visitor permissions needed checking before promising equal freedom. Our room needed the same ordinary clarity about whose thing was whose.

June returned the old jacket to Dez. Dez immediately offered it back for the walk to the car. This time June asked how long.

Dez returned the old jacket to June. Then Dez asked to borrow it for the walk to the car. June asked how long.

'Until you're cold,' Dez said.

Aiden’s verdict. Build the town if the chosen mode and visitor roles suit. Our borrowing agreement has successfully returned one jacket and left the portrait with its extensively documented purchaser.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched PC Steam description supports Australian-inspired survival, farming and online cooperation. Official launch announcements explicitly confirm the April 23, 2025 UTC exit from Early Access, Creative Mode and revised multiplayer permissions. Some town/building quests remain host-only in those launch notes. Current build behavior still needs checking; observed September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1062520/>

Source 2: https://store.steampowered.com/news/posts/?appids=1062520&enddate=1745490680&feed=steam_community_announcements

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P239 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Farm Together

Edition considered: PC first game

Grow and decorate a shared farm that keeps moving while you are offline, making return visits part of the pleasure without requiring continuous attendance from players.

What you do. Plant and tend crops, care for animals, arrange the farm and set permissions for friends helping with the ongoing work.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Repeated tending and expansion can become a workload; check camera controls, menus and permissions, and remember this is the first game.

Why it might click. Grow crops, keep animals, decorate a farm and invite other players to cultivate it together. The first Farm Together explicitly lets time progress while you are offline, creating a place that can be revisited rather than requiring continuous attendance.

The full catch. Repeated tending, expansion, currencies, waiting and item menus can become a workload. Movement and camera handling need a direct check. Online farm permissions matter when sharing; the source does not establish every activity as untimed or hold-free. This card covers the first game, not its sequel.

Try this first. Plant or tend one small area and inspect how a friend joins and what they may change. Try camera movement and a basic interaction. Decide whether returning to growing things feels pleasant without agreeing to an attendance schedule.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P239 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Farm Together

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Farm Kept Growing While the Pen Went Around

Farm Together's continuing little tasks made Tank wonder whether a place could carry on without its host supervising every minute. Rae looked at me. Nia looked at me. Shawna spared a glance.

I said I was sensing an unrelated agenda.

Rosa liked the idea of returning to a shared farm for a modest job. She also liked the right to leave it alone when dinner, sleep or other people sounded better.

June passed the signed page to Dez. Dez read the jukebox sentence once more, smiled and added her name. Nia signed beneath the agreed final wording with her magnificent, terrible handwriting.

Rae recognised it anyway.

The game's persistent work could become pleasant or burdensome depending on what people wanted. Our charter settled that nobody owed a game attendance simply because someone else loved it.

I signed last and discovered the portrait line had not secretly improved.

Shawna kissed my cheek. 'Congratulations, baby. Peace is official.'

'And expensive.' 'That part was official when you ordered the frame.'

Aiden's verdict. Return to the shared farm if its ongoing tasks remain pleasant. The coalition is signed, participation stays voluntary, and the portrait's continuing existence does not create collective financial responsibility.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified Steam app 673950 is the first Farm Together, published by Milkstone Studios. Product description explicitly supports shared farming, permissions and time advancing offline. These claims are not imported from Farm Together 2; exact control comfort remains untested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/673950/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P240 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Staxel

Edition considered: PC release

Restore a farm and shape a blocky village with friends online, sharing one place or becoming neighbours while building projects give the world personal character.

What you do. Move around the world, place building materials, grow crops and help villagers, coordinating a small farm or construction project with friends.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. First-person camera movement, crafting and precise block placement add demands; establish the session setup and check sustained inputs before building.

Why it might click. Restore a farm, meet villagers and alter a voxel world through building and cultivation. The PC game explicitly supports online cooperation, allowing friends to share a farm or become neighbours while making their own projects.

The full catch. First-person movement, camera steering, selecting materials, crafting and placing blocks can create substantial coordination and menu demands. Farming tasks add routine work. The publisher's creative premise does not certify no holds, no timed activities or a frictionless multiplayer setup.

Try this first. Try looking around, moving through a doorway and placing or interacting with a simple object. If sharing online, establish who owns the session and how both people join. Choose one small project only after the controls feel worth using.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P240 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Staxel

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Village Had Enough Room for a Dance

Staxel's shared village made Mika place the last two figures inside the miniature hotel. Rae and Nia stood on its little dance floor. My figure remained near the loading dock.

'A strong logistical role,' I said. 'A safe distance from the music controls,' Kit replied.

The signed agreement lay beneath the lamp. June and Dez had chosen different songs. Both selections would play. June's jacket waited over Dez's arm, borrowed again by asking.

The game's building and first-person controls still needed an actual trial. Our constructed room had already passed a simpler test: people could see, sit, leave and find each other.

Mercedes began the chosen music. Nia held out her hand to Rae. Rae took it without requesting another furniture inspection.

I offered Shawna my own hand. 'No introduction?' she asked. 'I'm trying a local custom.'

She came close. Velvet laughed beside the stage, Remy finally played the right fanfare, and nobody looked toward my portrait for permission.

Nigga, the place had become ours without becoming mine.

Aiden's verdict. Make a shared place if its camera and building demands suit. Our finished room offers a dance, an open door and absolutely no reimbursement for the face above it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified Steam app 405710 is Staxel, with explicit online co-op and shared-farm or neighbour play in the publisher description. Voxel building, village life and crops are supported. Camera workload and first trial are editorial checks, not access certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/405710/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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Everybody Chose a Song; Nobody Bought My Face

The signatures were real. June wrote slowly, Dez added hers with a seamstress's steady care, and Nia's name crossed the line like an adventurous bird. Rae recognised it and signed beside it. The others followed in an order nobody would need to defend for sixty years.

Dez unfolded the old rental invoice while Nia checked the new names. June pointed at her own 1967 signature. Dez turned the paper over. Hers was on the back.

Both women stared. 'You signed the wrong side,' June said. 'You read the wrong side,' Dez replied. Nigga, I had hired a convention floor to resolve a failure to turn over one sheet.

I signed last. The portrait still received no reimbursement.

'Perhaps a commemorative allowance,' I murmured.

Shawna took the pen from my hand. 'Perhaps enjoy your wife.'

Nigga, finally a motion I could support without amendment.

The agreement protected an ordinary evening. Choose a game, ask for help, watch or decline. Stop when you want. Share the actual controls by agreement. Let different interests occupy the same room without drafting a winner.

Dez returned the jacket to June, then asked to borrow it for the walk downstairs. June said yes, provided it came back before another jukebox became obsolete.

'You make me sound unreliable,' Dez said.

'Only with sleeves,' June replied.

They laughed. The Blue Comet war ended without anyone fixing the weather in the official account.

June's chosen jukebox song played first. Dez tapped the table, pretending she had not liked it since 1967. Her own choice followed, and June sang the chorus incorrectly with magnificent commitment.

Then Mercedes began the song Rae and Nia had chosen.

Nia put her pen down and held out her hand. Rae took it and stood. No further invitation. No scheduling language. They walked onto the floor as two women who had spent the evening finding each other interesting and now wanted to be close.

Nia counted one step, caught Rae smiling and stopped counting aloud. Rae laughed softly. Nia drew a little nearer. Their first turn was imperfect and entirely theirs.

I signalled the photographer out of habit. Porsche touched his arm before he moved. Rae glanced over, shook her head once, and the camera stayed down.

Shawna took both my hands. 'Your turn.'

'For the photograph?'

'For me, nigga.'

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

I followed her onto the floor. The giant portrait watched from above, useful at last because it could not interrupt.

Velvet finished her number to the applause it deserved. Remy's fanfare arrived at the right moment and still contained the terrible pun. Kit sang. Rosa leaned against Tank; Dre collected the casserole dish only after checking nobody wanted more.

Mika placed the model hotel beside the signed agreement. Its little door remained open.

Later, Dez draped half the borrowed jacket across June's shoulders while they waited for the lift. June pretended the division needed measuring. Dez pulled her closer and said the seam allowance was generous.

The hotel manager handed me the portrait transport charge.

I looked at Shawna. She looked back with no intention of rescuing my budget and every intention of staying beside me.

I paid it.

Then I folded the receipt, put it in my own pocket and returned to the woman holding out her hand. Peace had its own music. For once, I did not need to introduce the singer.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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